

Japan arrival checklist

First steps after landing: data, cash, IC card, and trains in a sane order.

Immigration and baggage

- ☐ Have passport, arrival card or QR, and address ready before the desk.
- ☐ Baggage claim first, then customs if asked. Do not rush past signs you do not understand.
- ☐ Photograph your baggage tag stub on your phone in case the belt delays.

Connectivity before you leave the terminal

- ☐ Install or activate your eSIM or SIM before you rely on airport WiFi for critical tasks.
- ☐ If you use a pocket WiFi pickup, confirm counter hours and exact desk name on your voucher.
- ☐ Download offline maps for your first hotel neighborhood as a backup.

Cash and cards

- ☐ Withdraw cash at a post office (Japan Post Bank) or 7-Bank ATM if cards fail elsewhere.
- ☐ Carry small notes for lockers, buses, and rural shops. Break large bills at a conbini if needed.
- ☐ Turn on travel notifications for your bank and know your card PIN.

IC card and first train

- ☐ Buy or load Suica or PASMO on your phone or plastic before you stand in a rush-hour gate line.
- ☐ Tap in and tap out on the same reader type. Do not mix JR and metro gates on one fare by mistake.
- ☐ Use one map app consistently. If a train is Local, it stops everywhere. Express skips stops.

Ground truth at the hotel

- ☐ Screenshot your hotel address in Japanese for taxis and late arrivals.
- ☐ Ask check-in time. Early bags often go to a locker or hold area, not the room.
- ☐ Note nearest conbini, ATM, and station exit for tomorrow morning.